



A carefully planned plot makes full use of available space and can look attractive.

and are sharing the space with, perhaps, a dining area or children's play space, consider this when you construct your plan. If you don't want a fence, a row of bean poles or fruit trees might protect your other crops from an errant football, while growing salad leaves close to a patio area might serve as an easy-access outdoor salad bowl. Consider mixing crops into flowerbeds for a more naturalized look—plants such as marigolds, nasturtiums, or basil act as companion plants, and can help

to divert insect predators. Keep in mind that you might need to plan ahead to prevent gaps in your flowerbed after harvesting.

RAISE YOUR BEDS

Creating raised beds for your crops not only provides them with deeper, better-draining soil that may warm up quicker in spring, but also adds architectural interest to your garden. Use old railroad ties, bricks, slates, or even wooden boards as edging, and then build up the level of the soil with good quality compost.